17.5 Gastroenteritis and Dehydration

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says • "He has had diarrhea and vomiting since yesterday." **Objective** • Eyes sunken, mouth dry • Skin turgor reduced • Hardly any wet diapers • Lost 5% of body weight	**ACTUAL** **Deficient fluid volume** related to fluid loss from diarrhea and vomiting as evidenced by sunken eyes, dry mucosa and weight loss.	Within 8 hours, mouth moist and urine output normal.	• Work out how dehydrated he is. • Give oral rehydration solution in small amounts, often, as prescribed. • If he is severely dehydrated, give IV fluids as ordered. • Record intake, output and weight. • Keep breastfeeding.	Rehydrated: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother says • "He has watery stools all day." **Objective** • 8 watery stools a day • Hyperactive bowel sounds	**ACTUAL** **Diarrhea** related to intestinal infection as evidenced by frequent watery stools.	Within 48 hours, fewer stools.	• Chart his stools. • Give zinc as prescribed. • Keep feeding him normally for his age. • Teach hand hygiene.	Fewer stools: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Many stools in the diaper	**RISK** **Risk for impaired skin integrity** as evidenced by risk factors: contact of stool with skin.	Skin in the diaper area stays intact.	• Change diapers quickly. • Clean gently and put on barrier cream. • Leave the skin open to the air when you can.	Skin intact: **goal met**.